

WITH THE MAESTRO Batiste is a seven-time Grammy winner, and won the Best Original Score Oscar in 2021 for *Soul*

CONCERTS ▼

Mr Eclectic Comes to Town

JON BATISTE IS BRINGING HIS GENRE-DEFYING BRAND OF MUSIC TO INDIA

WHEN ATTENDEES IN DELHI AND MUMBAI TAKE THEIR SEATS TO watch American singer-songwriter Jon Batiste play his Maestro series of concerts, the setting might seem like that of a Western classical music recital. Batiste, who released the interpretive album *Beethoven Blues* in 2024, will perform solo at the piano. But the show will span multiple styles of music, from jazz and blues to pop and soul to rock and funk.

The seven-time Grammy winner—



MUSIC ▼

NOTES THAT UNITE

The South Asian Symphony Orchestra demonstrates the harmony that is possible even in a divided world

In a time when divisions dominate public discourse, the South Asian Symphony Orchestra (SASO) offers a powerful counterpoint: the belief that music can build bridges where politics falters. When SASO returns to Bengaluru on November 29, it brings not just an evening of orchestral performance but a message of shared humanity.

Around 120 musicians from South Asia and the diaspora will gather at the Prestige Centre for Performing Arts under the direction of Alvin Arumugam. Their programme spans the nostalgic melodies of Raj Kapoor's films, European arias and Beethoven's Symphony No. 9, along with a special orchestral adaptation of a *nottuswara* by Muthuswami Dikshitar.

SASO will also appear in Chennai the following evening,

Beethoven's Ninth Symphony, with its rousing choral finale, is the centrepiece of SASO's Bengaluru concert